

The Historical Archaeologist

Nerve +2 | Notice +4 | Rapport +1 | Reason +3 | Vigor +0

You are **The Historical Archaeologist**. Someone anonymously sent you a box containing photographs, floor plans, correspondence, and property records from Mourning Bluff Manor that have never appeared in any archive. The documents establish that a previously unknown inheritor now owns the estate. The inheritor asked you to investigate the property and prove that its infamous hauntings are tricks, misunderstandings, or stories grown wild with age.

WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

The anonymous archive is genuine enough to demand investigation, but you do not know who assembled or sent it. The Inheritor brought you in for your professional judgment. You regard the manor as a historical site whose physical evidence can be permanently lost through careless handling. Your name, age, gender, appearance, occupation, relationships, and personal history are yours unless established above.

MAKE THE CHARACTER YOUR OWN

Choose your specialty: historic architecture, material culture, funerary practice, industrial archaeology, photographic history, local history, conservation, or something equally relevant. You may work for a university, museum, preservation office, private firm, or yourself. Decide whether this discovery could restore your reputation, define your career, answer a private question, or expose an institution that ignored the site.

DECIDE BEFORE PLAY

- What item in the anonymous box convinced you it was not an ordinary hoax?
- What professional mistake or triumph shaped your approach to fragile evidence?
- What part of the manor's history do you most hope to recover intact?

WEAKNESS: LEAVE IT INTACT

This manor is a historical site, and if I destroy any part of it, I could erase the truth I came to uncover.

When you deliberately damage or destroy part of Mourning Bluff Manor or one of its contents, discard your visible Premonition without revealing the next card. Make your next test blindly. After it resolves, reveal a new Premonition normally.

GIFT: FOLLOW THE EVIDENCE

The answer is already here; I only need to look closely enough.

Before making a Reason test to research documents or analyze physical evidence, look at the card directly beneath your Premonition. You may exchange the two cards.

If exchanged, the lower card becomes your new Premonition and the previous Premonition goes directly beneath it.

TOOL: FIELD NOTEBOOK

The notebook contains your written observations, measurements, sketches, rubbings, and loose research materials. You may add to it, consult it, show it to others, remove pages, or use it in any other way a physical notebook reasonably permits.

When you enter a room, you may carefully document one specific item or physical detail. Once recorded, that item or detail cannot change for as long as the entry remains intact in your notebook.

The house may change everything around it, but the recorded detail remains exactly as you described it. The entry must describe something concrete and observable, not a conclusion. You could preserve the position of a chair, the wording of a sign, the dimensions of a doorway, or the appearance of a portrait. You could not write that a room is safe or that a door leads outside.

If the relevant page is removed or destroyed, the detail is no longer protected.

SECRET

Create a Secret that your character must hide from the rest of the group. It should be something that could cause conflict if the others discovered it.

QUICK PLAY REFERENCE

Tests. Use your active Premonition, add the named Stat, and compare the total with the Difficulty. Beat it by 3 for a clean success; meet it or beat it by 1-2 for success with a consequence; below it fails. Minor cards. Ace: critical success and regain 1 Grounding. Page 11. Knight 12. Queen: automatic success and lose 1 Grounding. King: critical failure and lose 1 Grounding.					Major Arcana. A Major is never a test value. It changes the whole house, then every character resets their Premonition. Grounding. Begin with 6. At 0, you are Unmoored and draw blindly until an Ace or meaningful help in a place of safety restores you. Tools. Use your Tool in any physically reasonable way. No test is needed when it makes the outcome safe and certain.
NERVE	NOTICE	RAPPORT	REASON	VIGOR	
Endurance, courage, and sanity	Perception and awareness	Charisma and social influence	Intelligence, knowledge, and willpower	Strength, dexterity, and athletics	